if the conversion is fueled using solar energy, which is starting to take over from oil to power desalination plants in the Middle East. In parts of the world, there is seasonal heavy rain—for example, in countries with a monsoon—but it runs off into polluted rivers and cannot be used. Rainwater catchment and storage programs would help.

Other helpful initiatives include reducing pollution, cutting irrigation and industrial wastage, providing new technological solutions for developing countries, and reaching international agreements—after all, water catchments do not stick to national boundaries.

“There is no water-rich country in the world that is not facing problems.”

Maude Barlow